

THE SEVENTH DAY SABBATH

Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition?

Matthew 15:3. But he answered and said unto them, *Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition?*

Modern “Sabbath-keepers” believe, that so long as they **cease from work** from sunset Friday evening till sunset Saturday evening, that they are “Sabbath-keepers.” In this chapter it will be demonstrated that this method of “keeping the Sabbath” is a modern tradition (started in the 19th century, by a false prophet) and is not the same way of “keeping the Sabbath” as commanded by God at Mount Sinai.

Matthew 15:6. *Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition.*

It must be pointed out for the sake of “Sabbath-keepers” that **the New Testament does not declare how to keep the Sabbath after the death burial and resurrection of Jesus Christ.** *For non-“Sabbath-keepers” the reason is obvious. In the last chapter we demonstrated that the Ten Commandments are the Old Covenant, and that the Old Covenant has been abolished.* In this chapter we will approach this same conclusion, from a completely different starting point, the Sabbath. **We must expose the foundations of modern Sabbath-keeping as a mere house of cards that is not supported in the New Testament showing it no mercy.**

If men attempt to keep one of the Ten Commandments in a man-made way, it is useless, vain, and unprofitable.

Matthew 15:9. *But in vain they do worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men.*

Believing that ceasing from work from sunset Friday evening till sunset Saturday evening, each week, is the only requirement in the Law to be a “Sabbath-keeper,” is not scriptural. This modern way of how to keep the Sabbath, is entirely built upon assumptions, not scripture:

“The New Testament does not reenact The Law of the tithe, as it does not that of the Sabbath; for the validity of both is assumed.” — Ellen G. White, (The Seventh-Day Adventist’s False Prophet), The Review and Herald, May 16, 1882.

“Sabbath-keepers,” cannot 1. demonstrate exclusively from the Holy Bible that the Sabbath has

been re-enacted in the New Testament and continues to be binding today. Neither can “Sabbath-keepers,” produce any statement exclusively from the Holy Bible, that teaches 2. How to keep the Sabbath under the New Covenant, in a way that differs from how the Israelites were commanded to keep the Sabbath under the Old Covenant. How were the Israelites commanded to keep the Sabbath?

1. The Mount Sinai law did not permit the Israelites to leave their houses on the seventh day.
2. The Hebrews were not permitted to gather food, to prepare, or heat their food on the Sabbath.
3. The Israelite's were strictly commanded not to carry anything out of their houses.
4. Sabbath-keeping according to the Ten Commandments in Deuteronomy 5, required the Israelites to remember the Exodus (how God delivered the Hebrews from Egypt), each Sabbath.
5. Under the Mt. Sinai covenant, if a single person (even a stranger) violated the Sabbath within the gates of the city, that act caused every Israelite within that city to be guilty of breaking the Sabbath.

Modern "Sabbath-keepers" ignore every one of these requirements in the Law and the Prophets and insist that all "Sabbath-keepers" need to do, is cease from work on the Sabbath.

"Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition." "In vain they do worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men."

The Fourth Commandment Contained TWO Memorials.

Memorial #1. A Memorial of Creation.

Exodus 20:8-11. Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy. Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work: But the seventh day *is* the sabbath of the LORD thy God: *in it* thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that *is* within thy gates: **For *in* six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them *is*, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.**

Memorial #2. A Memorial of the Exodus.

Exodus 20:1-3. and God spake all these words, saying, I *am* the LORD thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. Thou shalt have no other gods before me.

Deuteronomy 5:12-15. Keep the sabbath day to sanctify it, as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee. Six days thou shalt labour, and do all thy work: But the seventh day *is* the sabbath of the LORD thy God: *in it* thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thine ox, nor thine ass, nor any of thy

cattle, nor thy stranger that *is* within thy gates; that thy manservant and thy maidservant may rest as well as thou. **and remember that thou wast a servant in the land of Egypt, and *that* the LORD thy God brought thee out thence through a mighty hand and by a stretched out arm: therefore the LORD thy God commanded thee to keep the sabbath day.**

Both Memorials Were Commands Spoken by God from Mt. Sinai.

Deuteronomy 5:22. These words the LORD spake unto all your assembly in the mount out of the midst of the fire, of the cloud, and of the thick darkness, with a great voice: and he added no more. and he wrote them in two tables of stone, and delivered them unto me.

Both Memorials Were Commands Written by the Finger of God on the Tables of Stone.

Deuteronomy 5:22 These words the LORD spake unto all your assembly in the mount out of the midst of the fire, of the cloud, and of the thick darkness, with a great voice: and he added no more. and **he wrote them in two tables of stone, and delivered them unto me.**

Under the Law, every “Jot and Tittle” of Both Memorials Must be Strictly Observed.

Matthew 5:18. For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, **one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law**, till all be fulfilled.

Deuteronomy 5:32. Ye shall observe to do therefore as the LORD your God hath commanded you: ye shall not turn aside to the right hand or to the left.

Thought question. Do you remember the Exodus story every seventh day Sabbath? If not, you do not keep every “Jot and tittle” of the 4th Commandment.

The 4th Commandment Carried a Death Penalty.

Under the Law, even a Minor Sabbath Violation Resulted in the Death Penalty.

Exodus 31:12-18. **and** the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, Speak thou also unto the children of Israel, saying, Verily my sabbaths ye shall keep: for it *is* a sign between me and you throughout your generations; that ye may know that I *am* the LORD that doth sanctify you. **Ye**

shall keep the sabbath therefore; for it is holy unto you: every one that defileth it shall surely be put to death: for whosoever doeth *any* work therein, that soul shall be cut off from among his people. Six days may work be done; but in the seventh *is* the sabbath of rest, holy to the LORD: **whosoever doeth any work in the sabbath day, he shall surely be put to death .** Wherefore the children of Israel shall keep the sabbath, to observe the sabbath throughout their generations, *for* a perpetual covenant. It *is* a sign between me and the children of Israel for ever: for *in* six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day he rested, and was refreshed. and he gave unto Moses, when he had made an end of communing with him upon mount Sinai, two tables of testimony, tables of stone, written with the finger of God.

Kindling a Fire on the Sabbath Resulted in the Death Penalty.

Exodus 35:2-3. Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day there shall be to you an holy day, a sabbath of rest to the LORD: **whosoever doeth work therein shall be put to death.** Ye shall kindle no fire throughout your habitations upon the sabbath day.

Gathering Sticks on the Sabbath Resulted in the Death Penalty.

Numbers 15:32-36. and while the children of Israel were in the wilderness, **they found a man that gathered sticks upon the sabbath day.** and they that found **him gathering sticks** brought him unto Moses and Aaron, and unto all the congregation. and they put him in ward, because it was not declared what should be done to him. and **the LORD said unto Moses, the man shall be surely put to death: all the congregation shall stone him with stones without the camp. and all the congregation brought him without the camp, and stoned him with stones, and he died; as the LORD commanded Moses.**

Leaving Your House was Strictly Forbidden on the Sabbath.

Exodus 16:29. See, for that the LORD hath given you the sabbath, therefore he giveth you on the sixth day the bread of two days; **abide ye every man in his place, let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.**

Carrying Anything “Out of Your Houses” Forbidden on the Sabbath.

Jeremiah 17:22. Neither carry forth a burden out of your houses on the sabbath day, neither do ye any work, but hallow ye the sabbath day, as I commanded your fathers.

Gathering, Preparing or Heating Food Strictly Forbidden on the Sabbath.

Exodus 16:23. and he said unto them, This *is that* which the LORD hath said, To morrow *is* the rest of the holy sabbath unto the LORD: bake *that* which ye will bake *to day*, and seethe that ye will seethe; and that which remaineth over lay up for you to be kept until the morning.

Carrying Sheaves, Wine, Grapes, Figs, and Fish Violated the Sabbath.

Nehemiah 13:15-21. In those days saw I in Judah *some* treading wine presses on the sabbath, and **bringing in sheaves, and lading asses; as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Jerusalem on the sabbath day:** and I testified *against them* in the day wherein they sold victuals. There dwelt men of Tyre also therein, **which brought fish, and all manner of ware, and sold on the sabbath unto the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem**. Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said unto them, **What evil thing is this that ye do, and profane the sabbath day?** Did not your fathers thus, and did not our God bring all this evil upon us, and upon this city? yet **ye bring more wrath upon Israel by profaning the sabbath.** and it came to pass, that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the sabbath, I commanded that the gates should be shut, and charged that they should not be opened till after the sabbath: and *some* of my servants set I at the gates, **that there should no burden be brought in on the sabbath day.** So the merchants and sellers of all kind of ware lodged without Jerusalem once or twice. Then I testified against them, and said unto them, Why lodge ye about the wall? if ye do *so* again, I will lay hands on you. From that time forth came they no *more* on the sabbath.

Carrying Burdens on the Sabbath Caused the Destruction of Jerusalem by Babylon.

Jeremiah 17:21-27. Thus saith the LORD; Take heed to yourselves, and **bear no burden on the sabbath day, nor bring it in by the gates of Jerusalem; Neither carry forth a burden out of**

your houses on the sabbath day, neither do ye any work, but hallow ye the sabbath day, as I commanded your fathers. But they obeyed not, neither inclined their ear, but made their neck stiff, that they might not hear, nor receive instruction. and it shall come to pass, if ye diligently hearken unto me, saith the LORD, to **bring in no burden through the gates of this city on the sabbath day, but hallow the sabbath day, to do no work therein**; Then shall there enter into the gates of this city kings and princes sitting upon the throne of David, riding in chariots and on horses, they, and their princes, the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem: and this city shall remain for ever. and they shall come from the cities of Judah, and from the places about Jerusalem, and from the land of Benjamin, and from the plain, and from the mountains, and from the south, bringing burnt offerings, and sacrifices, and meat offerings, and incense, and bringing sacrifices of praise, unto the house of the LORD. **But if ye will not hearken unto me to hallow the sabbath day, and not to bear a burden, even entering in at the gates of Jerusalem on the sabbath day; then will I kindle a fire in the gates thereof, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem, and it shall not be quenched.**

Jesus and His disciples Left Their Houses on the Sabbath.

Matthew 12:1. At that time Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn, and to eat.

Luke 6:1. and it came to pass on the second sabbath after the first, that **he went through the corn fields**; and his disciples plucked the ears of corn, and did eat, rubbing *them* in *their* hands.

Christ's Disciples Gathered Food on the Sabbath.

Matthew 12:1. At that time Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and **his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn, and to eat.**

Luke 6:1 and it came to pass on the second sabbath after the first, that he went through the corn fields; and **his disciples plucked the ears of corn, and did eat, rubbing them in their hands.**

Christ's Followers Were Commanded to Carry Burdens on the Sabbath.

John 5:8-18. Jesus saith unto him, **Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.** and immediately the man was made whole, and took up his bed, and walked: and on the same day was the sabbath. The Jews therefore said unto him that was cured, It is the sabbath day: it is not lawful for thee to carry thy bed. He answered them, He that made me whole, the same said unto me, **Take up thy bed, and walk.** Then asked they him, What man is that which said unto thee, Take up thy bed, and walk? and he that was healed wist not who it was: for Jesus had conveyed himself away, a multitude being in *that* place. Afterward *Jesus findeth him in the temple, and said unto him,* **Behold, thou art made whole: sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.** The man departed, and told the Jews that it was Jesus, which had made him whole. and therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the sabbath day. But Jesus answered them, **My Father worketh hitherto, and I work.** Therefore the Jews sought the more to kill him, because **he not only had broken the sabbath,** but said also that God was his Father, making himself equal with God.

*Not only had this man carried a burden **within the gates of Jerusalem** on the Sabbath day, but he had also carried this burden **"in the temple."***

Jeremiah 17:21-27. Thus saith the LORD; Take heed to yourselves, and **bear no burden on the sabbath day, nor bring it in by the gates of Jerusalem; Neither carry forth a burden out of your houses on the sabbath day...**

John 5:16. and therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the sabbath day.

Question. "Why do they on the sabbath day that which is not lawful?"

Answer. The Son of man is Lord of the sabbath.

Mark 2:24 and the Pharisees said unto him, **Behold, why do they on the sabbath day that**

which is not lawful?

Mark 2:28. **Therefore the Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath.**

The Weekly Seventh-day Sabbath was a Feast Day.

No one, not even the Jews are observing every jot and tittle of the Sabbath commandment in the Law of Moses today. Ever since the temple was destroyed in 70 A.D, it has been impossible for anyone to keep the Sabbath as commanded in the Torah!

Leviticus 23:2-4.

Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, **concerning the feasts of the LORD**, which ye shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even **these are my feasts**. six days shall work be done: but **the seventh day is the sabbath** of rest, an holy convocation; ye shall do no work therein: it is the sabbath of the LORD in all your dwellings. **these are the feasts of the LORD**, even holy convocations, which ye shall proclaim in their seasons.

Numbers 28:9-10.

And on the sabbath day two lambs of the first year without spot, and two tenth deals of flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, and the drink offering thereof: **this is the burnt offering of every sabbath**, beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.

Leviticus 23:37-38.

These are the feasts of the LORD, which ye shall proclaim to be holy convocations, to offer **an offering made by fire** unto the LORD, **a burnt offering**, and a **meat offering**, a **sacrifice**, and **drink offerings**, every thing upon his day: **beside the sabbaths of the LORD**, and beside your gifts, and beside all your vows, and beside all your freewill offerings, which ye give unto the LORD.

1 Chronicles 23:31.

And to **offer all burnt sacrifices unto the LORD in the sabbaths**, in the **new moons**, and on the **set feasts**, by number, according to the order commanded unto them, continually before the LORD:

2 Chronicles 2:4.

Behold, i build an house to the name of the LORD my god, to dedicate it to him, and to burn before him sweet incense, and for the continual shewbread, and for the **burnt offerings morning and evening, on the sabbaths**, and on the **new moons**, and on the **solemn feasts** of the LORD our god. This is an ordinance for ever to Israel.

2 Chronicles 8:12-13.

Then **Solomon offered burnt offerings unto the LORD on the altar of the LORD**, which he had built before the porch, even after a certain rate every day, offering according to the commandment of moses, **on the sabbaths**, and on the **new moons**, and on **the solemn feasts**, three times in the year, even in the **feast of unleavened bread**, and in the **feast of weeks**, and in the **feast of tabernacles**.

2 Chronicles 31:3.

He appointed also the king's portion of his substance for the burnt offerings, to wit, for the morning and evening burnt offerings, and **the burnt offerings for the sabbaths**, and for the **new moons**, and for the **set feasts**, as it is written in the law of the LORD.

Nehemiah 10:33.

For the shewbread, and for the continual meat offering, and for **the continual burnt offering, of the sabbaths**, of the **new moons**, for the **set feasts**, and for the holy things, and for the sin offerings to make an atonement for israel, and for all the work of the house of our god.

Ezekiel 46:4-5.

And **the burnt offering** that the prince shall offer **unto the LORD in the sabbath day** shall be six lambs without blemish, and a ram without blemish. 5 and the meat offering shall be an ephah for a ram, and the meat offering for the lambs as he shall be able to give, and an hin of oil to an ephah.

Ezekiel 45:16-17.

All the people of the land shall give this oblation for the prince in Israel. and it shall be the

prince's part to **give burnt offerings**, and meat offerings, and drink offerings, **in the feasts**, and in **the new moons**, and **in the sabbaths**, in all solemnities of the house of israel: he shall prepare the sin offering, and the meat offering, and the burnt offering, and the peace offerings, to make reconciliation for the house of israel.

Let no man judge you regarding holydays or the sabbath:

Colossians 2:14-17. Blotting out the handwriting of ordinances that was against us, which was contrary to us, and took it out of the way, nailing it to his cross; and having spoiled principalities and powers, he made a shew of them openly, triumphing over them in it. **Let no man therefore judge you in meat, or in drink, or in respect of an holyday, or of the new moon, or of the sabbath days:** Which are a shadow of things to come; but the body *is* of Christ.

There are no feast days or holydays in the New Covenant.

Saturday is no longer a holyday. Sunday is not a new holyday. Neither day is a Sabbath.

Romans 14:5. **One man esteemeth one day above another: another esteemeth every day alike .**

Let every man be fully persuaded in his own mind.

**Ye observe weekly Sabbath days, and months, and times, and years
in vain.**

***Galatians 4:10-11.** Ye observe days, and months, and times, and years. I am afraid of you, lest I have bestowed upon you labour in vain.*

	YEARLY	MONTHLY	WEEKLY
1 Chronicles 23:31	Fixed Festivals	New Moons	Sabbaths
2 Chronicles 2:4	Appointed Feasts	New Moons	Sabbaths
2 Chronicles 8:13	Annual Feasts	New Moons	Sabbaths
2 Chronicles 31:3	Fixed Festivals	New Moons	Sabbaths
Nehemiah 10:33	Appointed Feasts	New Moon	Sabbaths
Isaiah 1:13-14	Appointed Feasts	New Moon	Sabbath
Ezekiel 45:17	Appointed Feasts	New Moons	Sabbaths
Ezekiel 46:1-11	Appointed Feasts	New Moons	Sabbath
Hosea 2:11	Festal Assemblies	New Moons	Sabbaths
Galatians 4:10	Years	Months	Days

Colossians 2:16	a holyday	New Moon	Sabbath <i>Day</i>
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The Sabbath Commandment is a " Statute" and an " Ordinance."

In Ezekiel 20 the Sabbath & idolatry are the only commandments mentioned. They are both labeled as, "My statutes" and "My ordinances."

Verse 7. "...do not defile yourselves with **the idols of Egypt**; I am the Lord your God.

Verse 8. But they rebelled against Me ... nor did they forsake **the idols of Egypt**.

Verse 11. I gave them **My statutes** and informed them of **My ordinances**, by which, if a man observes them, he will live.

Verse 12. I gave them **My sabbaths** to be a sign between Me and them v13 Israel rebelled ... they did not walk in **My statutes** and they rejected **My ordinances**, by which, if a man observes them, he will live; and **My sabbaths** they greatly profaned.

Verse 16. ... because they rejected **My ordinances**, and as for **My statutes**, they did not walk in them; they even profaned **My sabbaths**, for their heart continually went after **their idols**.

Verse 19. I am the Lord your God; walk in **My statutes** and keep **My ordinances** and observe them.

Verse 20. Sanctify **My sabbaths**; and they shall be a sign between Me and you, that you may know that I am the Lord your God.'

Verse 21. ...did not walk in **My statutes**, nor were they Careful to observe **My ordinances**, by which, if a man observes them, he will live; they profaned **My sabbaths**.

Verse 24. ...because they had not observed **My ordinances**, but had rejected **My statutes** and had profaned **My sabbaths**, and their eyes were on **the idols of their fathers**.

Verse 25. I also gave them statutes and ordinances

Verse 39. As for you, O house of Israel," thus says the Lord God, "Go, serve everyone **his idols**; but later you will surely listen to Me, and My holy name you will profane no longer with your gifts and with **your idols**."

The law of commandments contained in ordinances has been abolished.

Ephesians 2:15. **Having abolished in his flesh the enmity, even the law of commandments contained in ordinances;** for to make in himself of twain one new man, so making peace;

Colossians 2:14. **Blotting out the handwriting of ordinances** that was against us, which was contrary to us, and **took it out of the way, nailing it to his cross.**

How was the Sabbath day against us, and contrary to us?

- **See:** The 4th Commandment Carried a Death Penalty. Also see,
- The Ten Commandments was a Ministration of Death
- The Ten Commandments was a Ministration of Condemnation.
- Justification by Mt. Sinai was only possible through perfect obedience to every precept of the Law.
- No One Is Able to Keep the Law.
- Jesus Christ is the ONLY Man Who has Ever Keep the Law.

Paul's Custom of Attending Jewish Synagogues on the Sabbath.

The New Testament does not give a single example of Christians conducting their religious services on the Sabbath. Synagogues were Jewish places of worship—Not Christian churches.

Objection, Acts 13:42, 44 Paul visited synagogues on the Sabbath.

“And when the Jews were gone out of the synagogue, the Gentiles besought that these words might be preached to them the next sabbath. . . . and the next sabbath day came almost the whole city together to hear the word of God.”

Synagogues were Jewish places of worship—not Christian churches. These men had originally assembled to read from Moses, according to the customs of Judaism—not to worship Jesus Christ. Paul's custom was to attend the Jewish synagogue to introduce Christianity to the Jews before preaching publicly on the streets of the city to the Gentiles. There is not a single example of Christians meeting in synagogues or keeping the weekly 7th-day Sabbath in the New Testament of the Holy KJV Bible.

Objection, Acts 16:13. Paul visited Jewish women on the Sabbath.

And on the sabbath we went out of the city by a river side, where prayer was wont to be made; and we sat down, and spake unto the women which resorted thither.

Bible Commentaries explain the Greek in this verse, and the customs of the smaller Jewish colonies who dwelt in foreign lands during the first century, so well, therefore it behooves us to examine them. Notice how all the Bible Commentaries are completely in agreement.

John Gill's Bible Commentary.

"Without the gate; and the Syriac version, "without the gates of the city"; all to the same sense: it looks as if there was no synagogue of the Jews in this place, or otherwise the apostle and his companions would have gone into that, according to their custom; and this the rather seems to be the case, since it is so particularly remarked, that at Thessalonica, the next place they stayed at there was one, Acts 17:1 and the reason might be, because that Philippi being a Roman colony, the Jews were not suffered to have one in it; wherefore Paul and his company, whether on the Jewish sabbath, or on any other day of the week, took a walk out of the city; either for the sake of a walk, or rather to converse together, and consider what was to be done, or to look out for an opportunity to preach the Gospel; and they came to a place,"

"Where prayer was wont to be made; or as the words may be rendered, "where was thought to be a place of prayer"; a "proseucha", an oratory, or a place built and made use of for prayer; that is, as they walked along, they saw a place, which in their opinion looked like a religious house, or a place for prayer, and so made up to it, where they found some persons assembled together on that account: this sense is confirmed by several versions.. . .the Arabic version, "we went out to a certain place, which was thought to be a place of prayer"; to which may be added the Ethiopic version, "and we thought there was prayer there"; and that the Jews had their oratories, or prayer houses, is certain."

Albert Barnes Bible Commentary.

Where prayer – Where there was a place of prayer, or where prayer was commonly offered. The Greek will bear either, but the sense is the same. Places for prayer were erected by the Jews in the vicinity of cities and towns, and particularly where there were not Jewish families enough, or where they were forbidden by the magistrate to erect a synagogue. These proseuchoe, or places of prayer, were simple enclosures made of stones, in a grove or under a

tree, where there would be a retired and convenient place for worship.

Was wont – Was accustomed to be offered, or where it was established by custom.

And spake unto the women ... – This was probably before the regular service of the place commenced.

Adam Clarke's Bible Commentary.

By a river side, where prayer was wont to be made – Οὐ ἐνομιζέτο προσευχῇ εἶναι, where it was said there was a proseucha. The proseucha was a place of prayer, or a place used for worship, where there was no synagogue. It was a large building uncovered, with seats, as in an amphitheatre. Buildings of this sort the Jews had by the sea side, and by the sides of rivers. See this subject considered at large in the note on Luke 6:12 (note). It appears that the apostles had heard from some of the Gentiles, or from some of the Jews themselves, that there was a place of prayer by the river side; and they went out in quest of it, knowing that, as it was the Sabbath, they should find some Jews there.

Spake unto the women – Probably this was before the time of their public worship, and while they were waiting for the assembling of the people in general; and Paul improved the opportunity to speak concerning Christ and salvation to the women that resorted thither.

Jamieson, Fausset, and Brown Bible Commentary.

where prayer was wont to be made — or a prayer-meeting held. It is plain there was no synagogue at Philippi (contrast Acts 17:1), the number of the Jews being small. The meeting appears to have consisted wholly of women, and these not all Jewish. The neighborhood of streams was preferred, on account of the ceremonial washings used on such occasions.

we sat down and spake unto the women, etc. — a humble congregation, and simple manner of preaching. But here and thus were gathered the first-fruits of Europe unto Christ, and they were of the female sex, of whose accession and services honorable mention will again and again be made.

Objection, Acts 17:2. Paul visited a synagogue on three Sabbath days.

“And Paul, as his manner was, went in unto them, and three sabbath days reasoned with them out of the scriptures,”

The New Testament does not give a single example of Christians conducting their religious services in Jewish synagogues or on the weekly 7th-day Sabbath in the New Testament of the Holy KJV Bible.

Acts 21:28. Crying out, Men of Israel, help: This is the man, that teacheth all *men* every where against the people, and the law, and this place: and further brought Greeks also into the temple, and hath polluted this holy place.

1 Corinthians. 9:19-23 For though I be free from all *men*, yet have I made myself servant unto all, that I might gain the more. and unto the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain the Jews; to them that are under the law, as under the law, that I might gain them that are under the law; To them that are without law, as without law, (being not without law to God, but under the law to Christ,) that I might gain them that are without law. To the weak became I as weak, that I might gain the weak: I am made all things to all *men*, that I might by all means save some. and this I do for the gospel's sake, that I might be partaker thereof with *you*.

Paul was a tentmaker by trade. He worked during the week to provide for himself so that no one could accuse him of being in ministry only to get others money! Meeting in the synagogue on the Sabbath was the best time to meet with large numbers of people and share the gospel with people who already believed the scriptures were from God. It only made good sense!

John Gill's Bible Commentary.

Hebrews 10:25 Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together,.... Or the episynagogue of one another; which word is used to distinguish Christian assemblies from Jewish synagogues, and to denote the coalition of Jews and Gentiles in one church state, and to express the saints' gathering together to Christ; see 2Th 2:1 and their act of meeting together in some one place to attend his worship, word, and ordinances.

Objection, Acts 18:4. Paul visited a synagogue on the Sabbath.

“And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, and persuaded the Jews and the Greeks.”

Once again, these examples are not Christian gatherings, rather they are taking place in “a

synagogue of the Jews.” The purpose of Paul’s visit was to reason with the Jews out of the scriptures concerning Jesus Christ.

“persuaded them to continue in the grace of God.” Acts 13:43.

“...reasoned with them out of the scriptures,” Acts 17:1-2.

“And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, and persuaded the Jews.” Acts 18:4.

Objection, Matthew 24:20. “Pray ye that your flight be not on the sabbath day.”

“But pray ye that your flight be not in the winter, neither on the sabbath day:”

Barnes Commentary

Long **journeys were prohibited** by the law on the Sabbath, Exodus 16:29. . . . It should be added that it was almost impracticable to travel in Judea on that day, as **the gates of the cities were usually closed**, Nehemiah 13:19-22.”

Clarke’s Commentary.

“That you may not raise the indignation of the Jews by traveling on that day, and so suffer that death out of the city which you had endeavored to escape from within. Besides, on the Sabbath-days the Jews not only kept within doors, but **the gates of all the cities and towns in every place were kept shut and barred**; so that their flight should be on a Sabbath, they could not expect admission into any place of security in the land.”

‘The People's New Testament’ Bible Commentary.

“Because then the gates of the city were closed, preventing departure.”

Objection, Luke 23:56. “On the Sabbath they rested according to the commandment.”

“And on the Sabbath they rested according to the commandment. “

Let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.

“Abide ye every man in his place, let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.” **Exodus 16:29.**

Those who lived in the country were not permitted to travel on the Sabbath and had to remain in their homes. Those living in the cities were only permitted to travel from their homes to the

synagogues and then back home so long as it was within the allotted "Sabbath Days Journey" of 2000 paces. This is why the Women had to rush home before the Sabbath - after all, they were only permitted 2000 paces to move around on the Sabbath. "On the sabbath they rested according to the commandment." Luke 23:54-56, Luke 24:1

The Sabbath Commandment Prevented the Women from Preparing the Body of Christ for Burial.

Luke 23:56. and they returned, and prepared spices and ointments; and rested the sabbath day according to the commandment.